



GUSTAV HOLST, 1927

This portrait by John Bernard Munns shows Holst in his early fifties, bespectacled, with bags under his eyes, looking tired and somewhat despondent. In the 1920s, the composer was placed under tremendous stress from overwork and the demands of his increasing fame—on doctor's orders, he retreated to the Essex countryside and significantly reduced his writing, teaching, and other work commitments.